

Discord Redesign Phase 3

Peter Tien Trinh
ptrinh32@gatech.edu

Abstract— Over the past eight years since its initial release date, Discord has become a prevalent communication social platform in which countless people use on a daily basis. The main functionalities of Discord include instant messaging, voice calls, and video calls for individuals and groups. The main task that I will be discussing involves Discord's group voice channels for group users.

1 BRAINSTORMING PLAN

Discord's group voice channel's interface is the focus of the redesign brainstorming. Before beginning brainstorming, the criteria that I will try to meet is to be able to come up with at least five redesigns of the current interface within an hour and fifteen minutes. Each design will be allotted fifteen minutes. The redesigns will begin with minor changes for the first design and continue to change more as the redesign numbers increase so that the first redesign will be similar to the original while the last will be the most different from the original interface design. Each design will list one to two changes from the previous design. The objectives to meet for the redesigns will be a design that is more user friendly, especially towards new users, and more user error tolerant.

2 BRAINSTORMING EXECUTION RESULTS

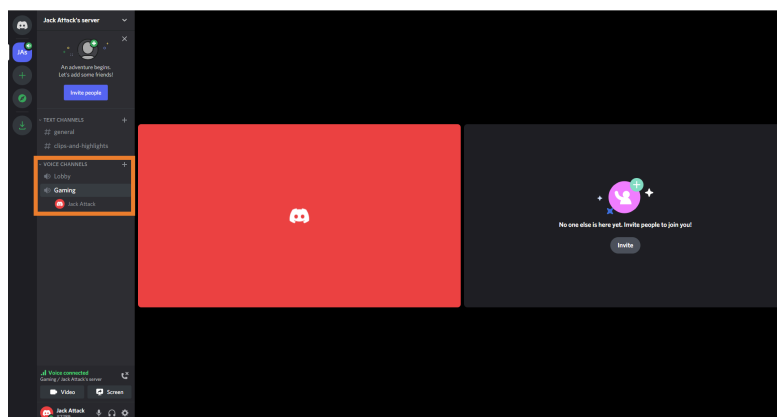


Figure 1—Discord's current voice channel interface. Source: [Image](#)

Each of the five redesigns changes more on the previous design to create multiple iterations of the current Discord voice channel interface. Each design will be focused towards either improving the interface's user friendliness or human error tolerance.

2.1 Design 1

- Possibly incorporate other design changes
- Add Join Button next to voice channel names
- Remove Open Chat Button and Create Invite Button to only show up when user right clicks on voice channel names instead of when mouse hovers voice channel name

2.2 Design 2

- Possibly incorporate other design changes
- Redesign Leave Channel Button to tell the user to click on the button to leave current channel
- Move Leave Channel Button to where voice channel name will be when user is already in channel

2.3 Design 3

- Possibly incorporate other design changes
- Add color change to voice channel name to indicate voice channel in use
- Add down arrow next to voice channel name to allow user to display current users in voice channel instead of always displaying users

2.4 Design 4

- Possibly incorporate other design changes
- Create a small box grid right below name of server to show current voice channel and user's inside channel
- Create small popup confirming the user wants to enter or leave a voice channel

2.5 Design 5

- Possibly incorporate other design changes
- Move user voice channel info at the bottom of the current grid into Design 3's new current voice channel display

3 SELECTION CRITERIA

Learnability is the main requirement for the interface, since the current interface does not assist users in learning how to utilize the interface. Due to this fact, the improvement in user friendliness and error tolerance is crucial. Out of the five designs, I will prioritize designs that have the most emphasis on one of these two points. If a design does not contribute to one of these improvements then it will not likely be considered over other designs. This will be the main rule in the selection of the prototype.

4 VERBAL PROTOTYPE

The design that will be explained through a verbal prototype will be design 1. This design is centered around the implementation of a crucial “Join” button for the user. This implementation works toward improving the user friendliness of the current interface. The verbal prototype will be a script depicting how the design will differ from the original and how the implementation can improve a new user’s experience. The user will be looking at a picture of the current interface for reference.

4.1 Script

- Myself: “Please take a look at the current interface of Discord’s voice channel. Can you identify where you would need to click to join a voice channel?”
 - User: “Yes”
 - User: “No”
 - Show user where to click
- Myself: “Now please imagine that instead of the two buttons next to the voice channel name, there is a button telling you that you can join the voice channel if you click on it instead.”
- Myself: “Would this change be easier for you to be able to use the voice channel functionality of Discord?”
 - User: “Yes”
 - User: “No. I already know you just need to click on the name to join a voice channel and the other buttons are gone.”
- Myself: “All the previous buttons next to the voice channel name are moved to the right click menu on voice channel instead. Does the new placement of the buttons create such a big impact?”

- User: "No."
- User: "Yes, the buttons there were more convenient."
- Myself: "The chat button is irrelevant since the text channels are still on the screen. The create invite button takes the same number of clicks as clicking on the settings button and right clicking. There is no difficulty changing either."

4.2 Redesigns

This prototype's redesign revolves around adding in a "Join" button next to the voice channel names. With this addition, the other buttons that were originally in this position will be removed. Both of the buttons can be accessed either through right clicking on the voice channel name or by clicking on the text channel itself.

4.3 Evaluation

This prototype's main contribution is towards the user friendliness of the interface. The current design of Discord does not allow new users to learn how to use voice channels easily. With a simple addition of the "Join" button and the removal of unnecessary buttons, the interface can emphasize more important aspects of the application. In addition, the user is given more explicit instructions on how the functionality is used. With this improvement, the user friendliness and invisibility of the interface are both greatly strengthened. This improves the interface's overall learnability towards new and novice users of Discord.

5 TEXTUAL PROTOTYPE

The next design that I will be creating using a prototype will be design 2, while also incorporating in design 1 as well. Textual prototype will be the type that will depict the prototype I created.

5.1 Redesigns

This prototype design incorporates both design 1 and 2. However, I will be focusing on design 2. The design on this prototype will include changing the "Leave" button for voice channels. Currently, this button on Discord is placed at the bottom of the grid of text and voice channels. However, this button is only placed in the corner of the grid being displayed as a phone with an "X" on it. The redesign in this prototype will be completely removing the current button and adding a new "Leave" button right next to the voice channel name. In addition,

the design of the button itself will be changed to be larger and explicitly say "Leave". The color of the button itself will also be made red to signify its importance to the user. To exit the current voice channel that the user is in, the user must click on the "Leave" button to be able to properly close the channel. In design 1, the "Join" button will be where the new "Leave" button will be. To resolve this conflict, the buttons will change depending on the user's status in a voice channel. If a user is currently not in a voice channel then the button will be utilized to "Join" a voice channel. However, if the user is already currently in the voice channel then instead of a "Join" button, the interface will have a "Leave" button instead. This change of the "Leave" button will not restrict other possible ways the user can exit a voice channel, such as joining another voice channel or the secondary leave button when the user is on the user channel display screen.

5.2 Evaluation

Learnability is the requirement behind the Discord interface redesigns. Similar to design 1, this design prototype emphasizes having the user be able to learn how to use the Discord voice channel interface easier. By narrowing the joining and leaving of the voice channels in one location, the user is able to better maneuver through the interface without having to spend excessive time learning specific placement of different buttons. First time user's of Discord will be able to have a lower learning curve in the interface. This design focuses on improving user friendliness and allowing users to focus more on his or her desired tasks through increased invisibility of the interface.

6 PAPER PROTOTYPE

The last design that I have chosen to create a prototype for is design 4. This design will be depicted through the use of a paper prototype. This design was chosen due to its improvement in human error tolerance.

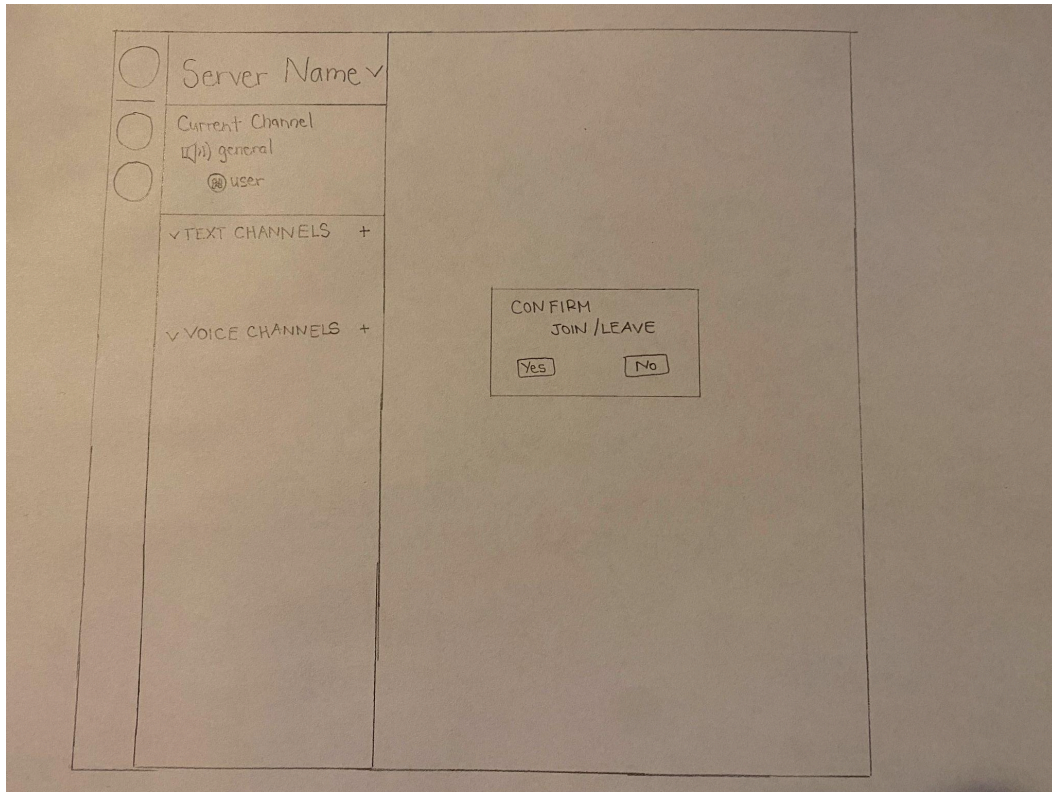


Figure 2—Design 4 paper prototype. Source: hand drawn picture

6.1 Redesigns

The redesign in this prototype includes two changes. The first is the addition of an extra display box when the user is entering or leaving a voice channel. The display box will prompt the user to hit “Yes” or “No” when he or she is trying to join or leave. The second addition is the creation of a new grid box underneath the current server name. This box will incorporate the user’s current voice channel and the users currently in the channel.

6.2 Evaluation

Human error is an unavoidable problem with any type of interface. With the current interface, joining and leaving a Discord voice channel is seamlessly automatic. Once a user clicks on a voice channel, he or she will immediately enter the voice channel with only a sound and name addition under the voice channel name to indicate to the user. With the new pop up that allows the user to confirm whether or not the user wants to enter a voice channel, he or she will be able to be more flexible with the user of the interface instead of accidentally joining

random channels. In addition, with a new grid box that clearly shows the user whether or not he or she is currently in the channel, the user has a secondary confirmation on whether or not he or she is properly entering or leaving a channel. Both of these redesigns allow the interface to improve its human error tolerance. This is a direct improvement in the interface's learnability and allows new users to freely explore the interface and learn how to use the application properly.